VINCENT LE QUANG · GAME & INTERFACE DESIGNER WHO SHIPS

I design games people can read in one glance, *then I build them end to end.*

Interface, levels, art, animation, music and code, all by one pair of hands, from 48-hour jams to Steam. Thirteen years of deciding what a player sees first, what a button must never do, and how a game stays playable with one finger or no eyes at all.



KEY ART, THE SUPERNATURAL POWER TROLL, 2024

~60 games shipped

3 on Steam, 2 on Google Play, 2 on the App Store, the rest on itch.io and Newgrounds.

Every pixel mine

UI, sprites and cutscenes in Aseprite, music in Beepbox, voices, animation, level editors.

Accessible since 2014

A game played with eyes closed. A platformer with one button. Subtitled synthetic speech.

01 / 04

The Supernatural Power Troll

Puzzle platformer · GameDev.js Jam 2024 → Steam, December 2024 · design, art, UI, levels, editor, music · solo



Main menu. The whole cast drawn by hand, three choices, nothing else competing for attention.

THE BRIEF

A 48-hour jam on the theme “Power”: you are a troll who hands humans chaotic superpowers. Then a Steam release with fifty levels, bosses, cutscenes and a level editor. Every screen had to read instantly in pixel art, and the humans had to feel alive.

DESIGN DECISIONS

- One key, one door, one exit per level. Fruit is the only safe way to touch a human.
- The HUD is score and lives, nothing more. The first vase on the first ledge is the tutorial.

- Humor is the state signal: what a human says tells you what you just did to them.



Level 1 is the tutorial

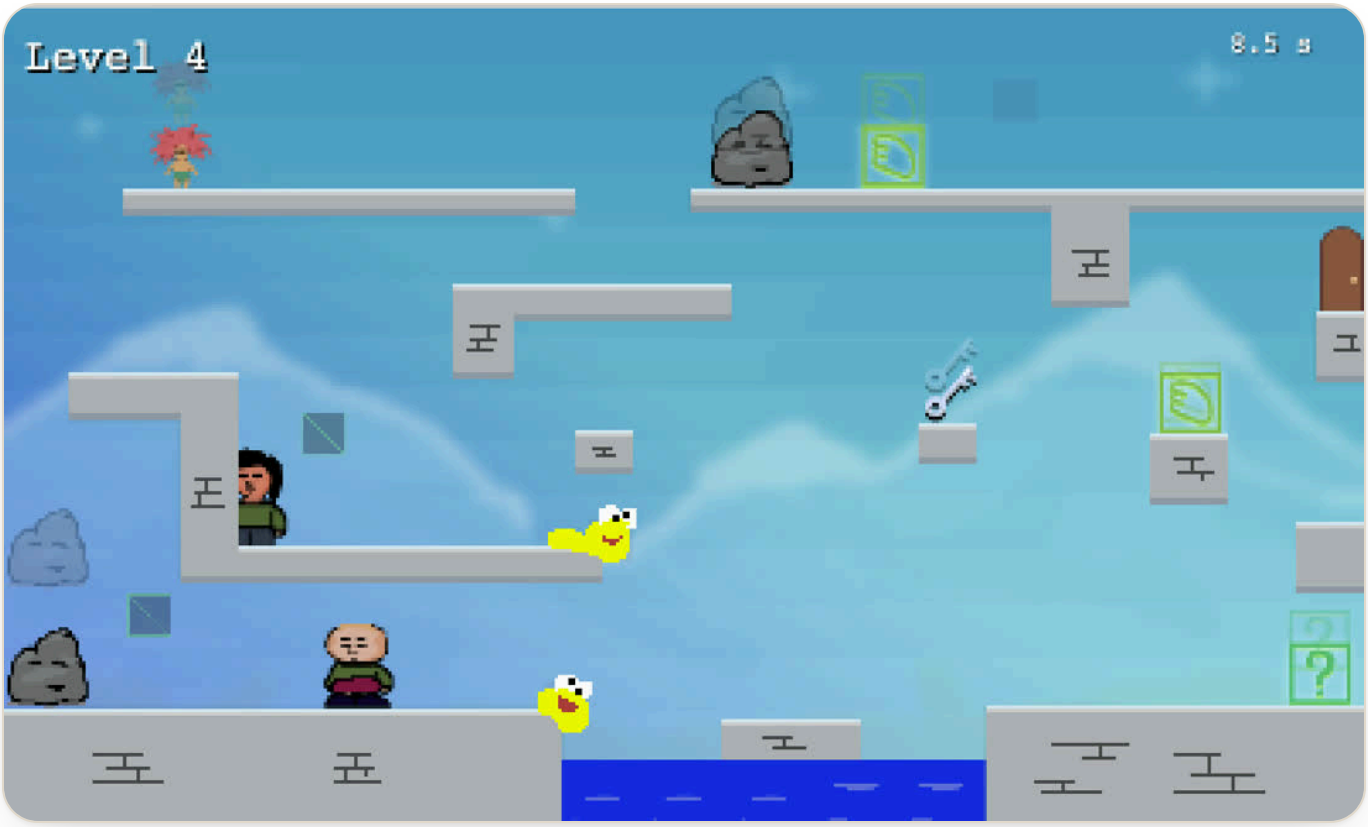
Key, platforms, a sleeping rock, the door. Nothing you cannot name in a second. The first level teaches the three verbs of the game without a single line of text, and every later level is a variation on that sentence.



NPCs that talk back

Every human is assembled at random from drawn parts, given a personality, and their dialogue is generated as you play and read by a speech synthesizer in a random voice, always subtitled.

The design problem was not the technology but restraint: dialogue appears only on events, stays short, is always subtitled, and never blocks the player.



An editor sized for players, not for me

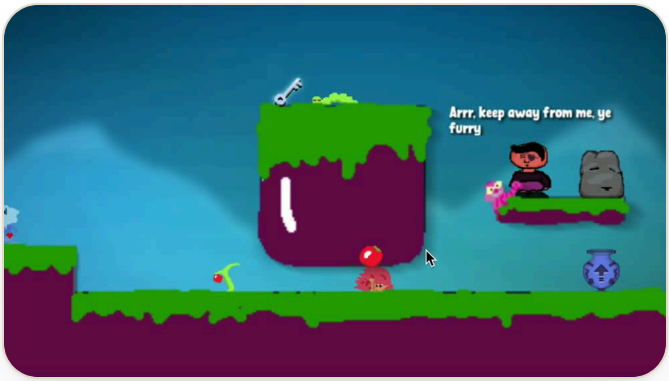
The in-game editor shows only what a player needs to build a level in minutes: platforms, items, humans. Everything else is hidden. Levels are plain JSON, so the community set lives in its own public repository and “Browse user levels” sits on the main menu next to “New game”.



Hand-drawn cutscene panels carry the story between levels.



Later levels add bosses and crowds, never a new HUD element.



Level 5 in motion.

Process FROM JAM BUILD TO STEAM

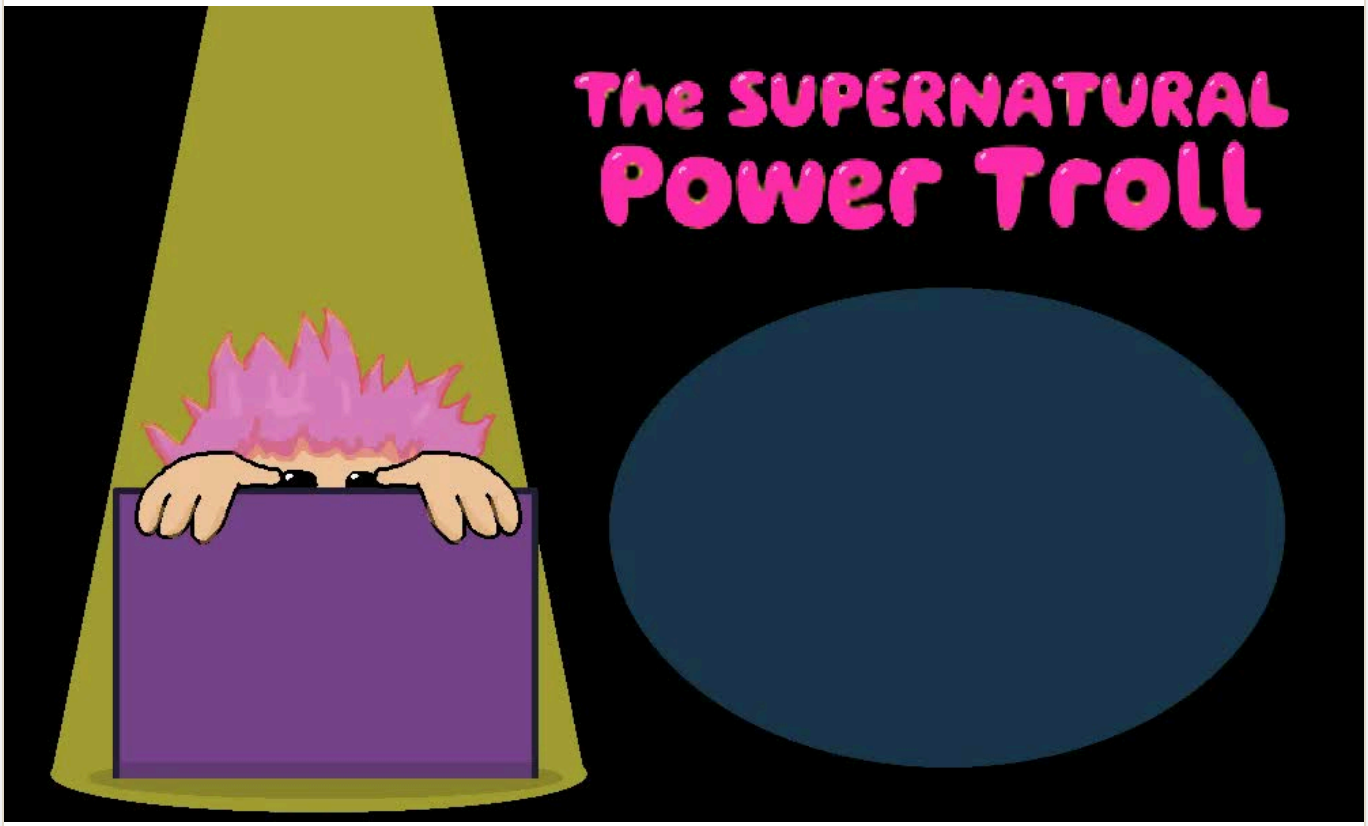


Forty-eight hours in: translucent blocks, a blue mountain backdrop, and humans who did not yet talk.

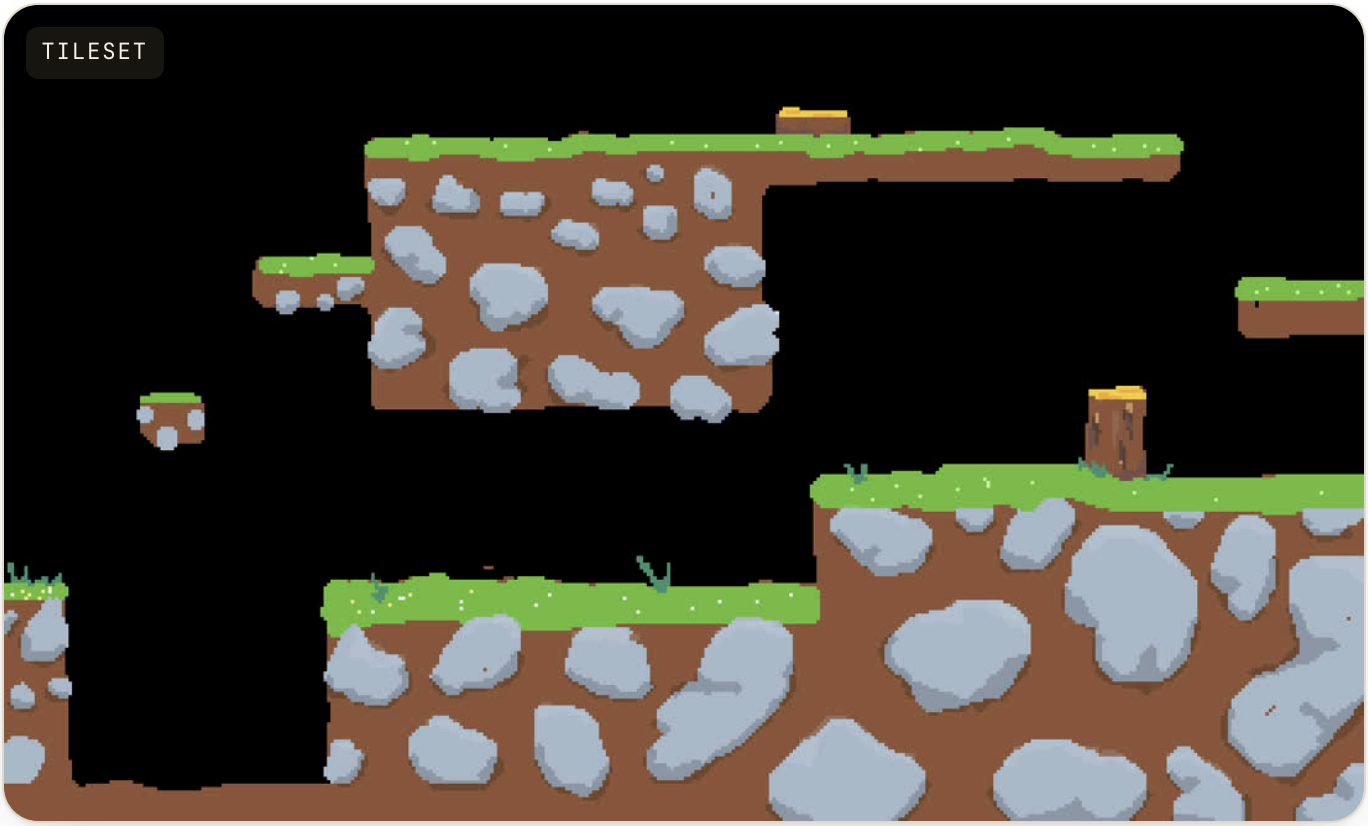


Eight months later: grass ledges and rocks you can read at a glance, bosses, and a cast that comments on what you do.

FIRST TITLE MOCK



The first title mock: the troll peeking over a box under a spotlight, an empty oval where the cast would go.



The tileset that replaced the translucent blocks: every edge and corner a ledge can need, drawn once.

WHAT GOT THROWN AWAY

The game started as a high-school setting (the source folder is still called `hischool`) and became an outdoor fantasy world of grass ledges, rocks and doors. The humans kept their school-kid look, which is part of why they feel out of place, and why it is funny.

HOW IT WAS MADE

Forty-eight hours for the jam build, eight months to the Steam release. 63 Aseprite source files for sprites, bosses and cutscene panels; every level a 150-line JSON with named layers (ground, key, door, rock, human, monster). The backlog still ends with “Collectible? Secret doors? Crates?”: ideas that stayed ideas so the game could ship.

✓ SHIPPED Steam · itch.io · Kotaku listing · write-ups on dev.to ·

Art in Aseprite, music in Beepbox, sound in ZZFX.

02 / 04

World of Turtle

Sokoban puzzle · BASIC (ASCII) → Flash on Newgrounds, 2011–2013 → TypeScript / WebGL on Steam and Google Play, 2023 · design, art, UI, 100 levels · solo



Conveyor arrows, breakable planks, crocodiles, and Babo Turtle one move from the exit.

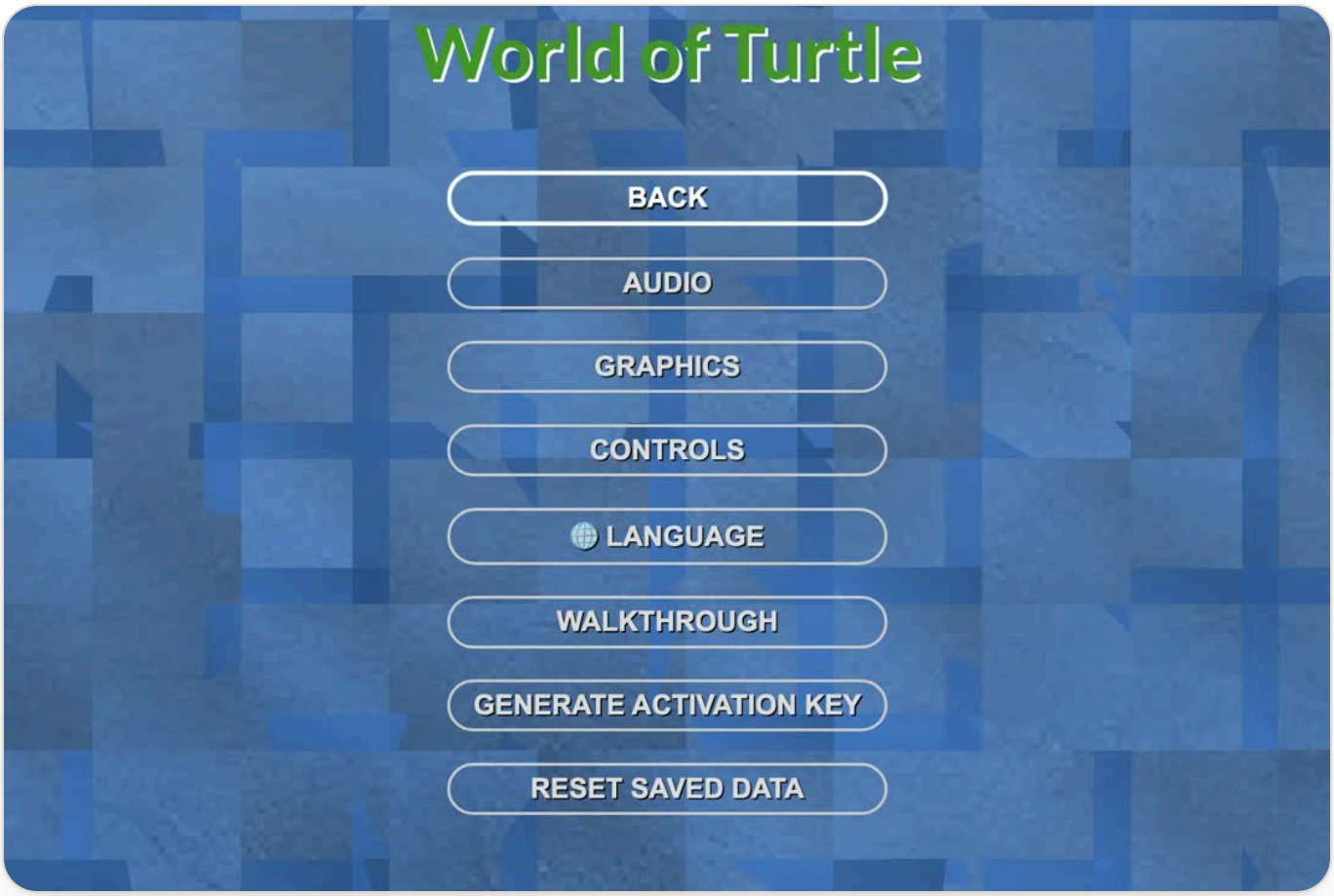
THE BRIEF

The same puzzle game rebuilt three times across twelve years. The rules never changed: push, collect fruit, reach the exit. The interface changed every time: ASCII to sprites, mouse to touch and gamepad, a web page to a Steam window.

DESIGN DECISIONS

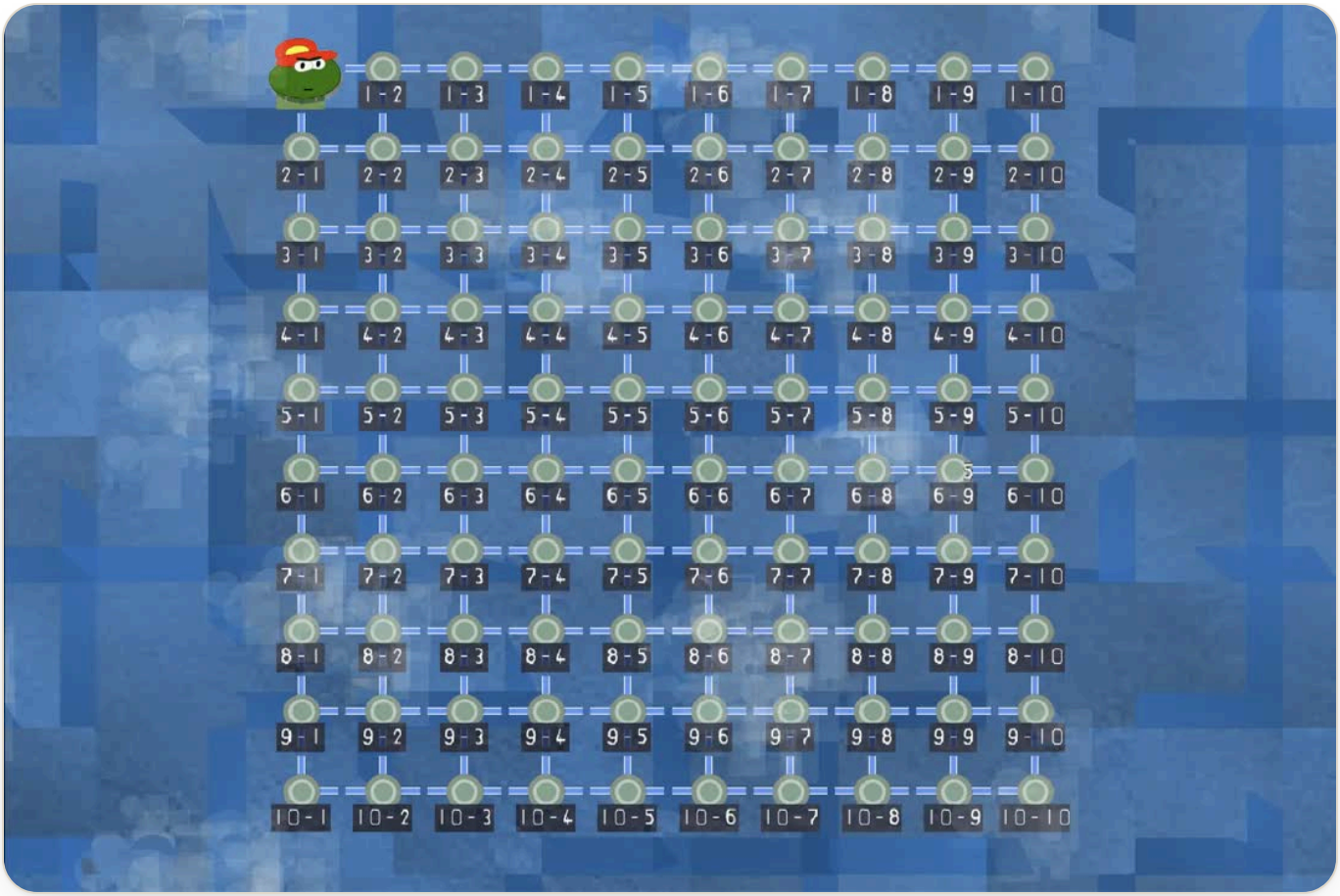
- The grid is drawn in 2.5D so height and gaps read without a legend.

- Keyboard, gamepad and touch are all first-class, AZERTY and QWERTY both.
- Five level-skip passes that you earn back, so a stuck player is never stuck for good.
- One menu column, big targets, nothing nested more than one level deep.



Settings in one column

Every input method is treated as the main one, so the menu has to work with a thumb, a stick and a mouse. One column, eight wide targets, no sub-menus you can get lost in.

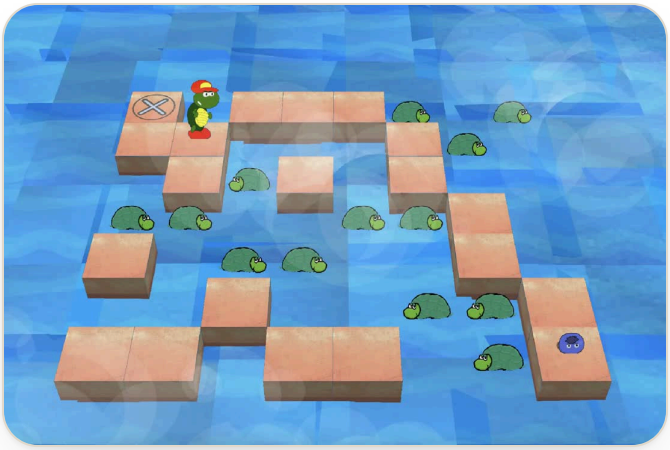


A hundred levels on one screen

Ten stages of ten. The whole game fits on one screen, so progress is something you see rather than something you are told. Each stage introduces one new element, and a skip pass lets you jump a wall without leaving the grid.



Ice, penguins and gorillas, stage by stage.



Crocodiles: the water is not empty.



Penguins only move on ice. The level teaches it by itself.

Process TEACHING WITHOUT A TUTORIAL



The rule is written on the water next to the level that needs it, three sentences, then the game gets out of the way.



The whole brief in two sentences, delivered by a character instead of a dialog box.

WHAT GOT THROWN AWAY

Separate tutorial screens. The remaster puts each new rule in the world, beside the first level that uses it, and never interrupts. There is no lives counter either: a Sokoban is about undoing, so progress is kept as you go and the only scarce resource is the skip pass.

HOW IT WAS MADE

Ten stages of ten levels, each stage built around a new element (ice, conveyors, breakable planks, penguins, gorillas, crocodiles) introduced on its own before it is combined with the others. The 2.5D grid replaced the flat Flash view so that height and gaps are visible without a legend. Three languages shipped with full audio.

✓ SHIPPED Steam · Google Play · itch.io demo ·

English, French and Korean, full audio and subtitles · a jukebox DLC with one song per stage, all composed by me.

03 / 04

Designing for one button, or no eyes

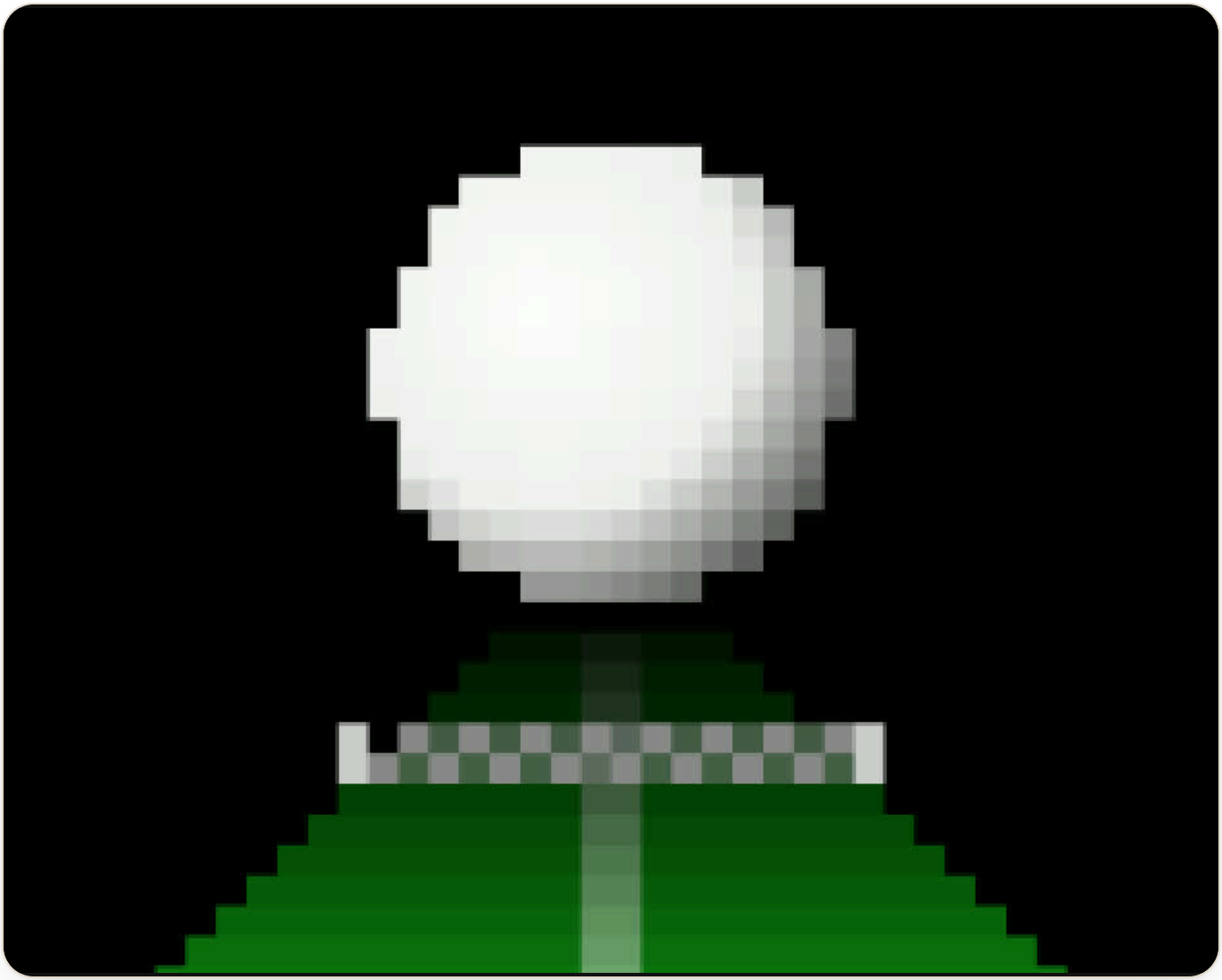
Blink Pong and Darwin Gator · LowRezJam and AccessibilityJam, 2014 · App Store and Google Play · solo

BLINK PONG

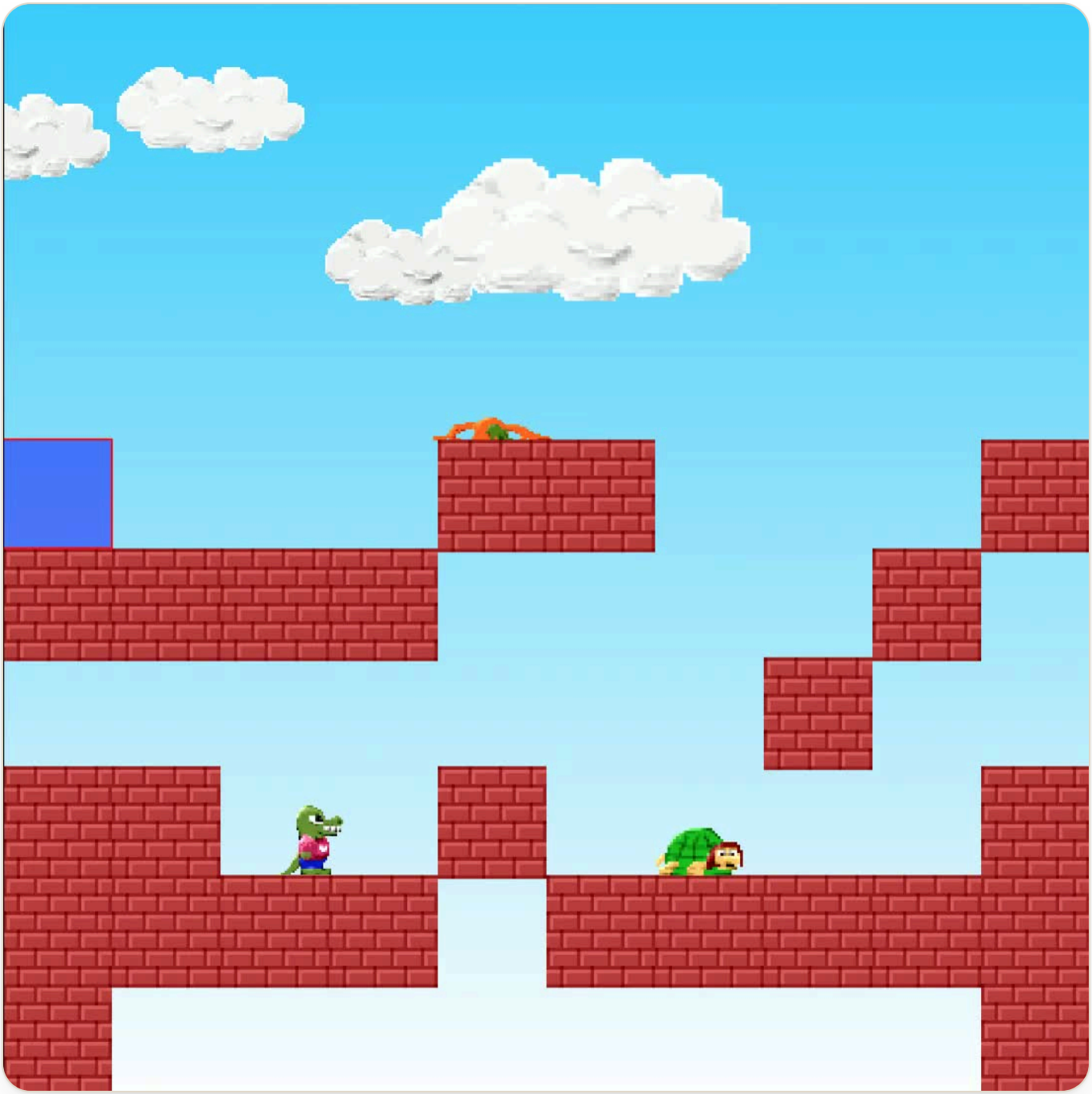
A ping-pong game you can play with your eyes closed. You do not aim; you time. The bounce tells you where the ball is, a voice announces score and level, and the only input is one button. Vision, cognition and motor load each reduced to one thing.

DARWIN GATOR

Five one-button games in one, with bosses and three stages, for players with motor disabilities. The constraint shaped every mechanic: if it cannot be done with a single press, it is not in the game.



Blink Pong. The ball is where the sound is. The whole game in 32×32 pixels.



Darwin Gator. A full platformer on a single button: jump is the only verb.

Process ONE LOAD AT A TIME

VISION

Remove it as a requirement, not as a feature. The table and paddle each have a distinct hit sound, so the ball is where the sound is. Score and level are spoken.

The screen still draws the game for sighted players.

COGNITION

One decision per moment: hit now, or not. No aiming, no power, no spin. Difficulty comes from timing windows, never from more things to track.

MOTOR

One input, any input: a mouse button, any key, a tap. Darwin Gator takes the same rule into a platformer: running, bosses and missions are all designed around when you press, not what you press.

Two jams, one game. Blink Pong was entered in LowRezJam (the whole game in a 32×32 pixel canvas) and AccessibilityJam at the same time. The two constraints pulled the same way: when you cannot rely on the picture, you design the sound and the timing first, and the picture becomes a bonus. That order of work, sound and rhythm before pixels, is the one I still use.

✓ SHIPPED Blink Pong · Darwin Gator ·

both in the Dobuki Game Anthology. The same instinct shows up ten years later in Power Troll's subtitled speech and in World of Turtle's skip passes.

04 / 04

Three more, briefly

An adventure game, a 13-kilobyte roguelike, and a launcher for twenty-three games.



Dobuki's Epic Journey

STEAM, 2023 · ADVENTURE / RPG

An adventure across three planets, non-linear, with skill progression and a cast of hand-drawn characters. Inventory, dialogue and map had to coexist on one small screen without a tutorial.



The Terror of Mongolia

JS13KGAMES 2023 · 12TH PLACE

A whole game, art and music included, in 13 KB of JavaScript. When every byte is an interface decision, you learn what a screen really needs.



Dobuki Game Anthology

2017 · LAUNCHER FOR 23 GAMES

Twenty-three Flash games from 2013 to 2017 in one application. A two-column list that fits every title without scrolling, a card with release date, player count and a one-line hook, a star to favorite, one orange Play button.

> *“My first fully finished project is World of Turtle, which was a real breakthrough for me.”*
>
> FROM THE NOTE THAT OPENS THE ANTHOLOGY, 2017

About

The engineer on the other side of the handoff

I have made games since 2013 under the name **Dobuki Studio**: about sixty of them, three on Steam, from one-hour jams to year-long releases. I draw, animate and compose everything you see and hear in them. I write about the craft on dev.to and I volunteer with Adobe Youth Voices helping students edit video.

By day I am a Staff Software Engineer at Skydio on the Remote Flight Deck team, the web cockpit that pilots a drone from miles away, and I hold an FAA Part 107 remote pilot certificate. Before that: Amazon (Astro, GameLift), Thumbtack, Storm8, Adobe, K-Factor Media, and a Microsoft research contract on learning games for children.

I know what it is like to be the engineer on the other side of a Figma handoff, which is exactly why I want to be on the design side of it.

TOOLS

Aseprite · Beepbox · ZZFX · TypeScript · React · WebGL · Phaser · Unity · Storybook · Chromatic · Axe · Figma, leveling up with AI in the loop

LINKS

LinkedIn · itch.io · GitHub · Steam · Résumé

French and English, bilingual.

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Designed in Figma, built by hand. No framework, no tracking.